

07

The h-Pawn and g-Pawn Storm

h4-h5, g4-g5, and the precise contact points that turn space into open files.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will advance kingside pawns only when the resulting files, squares, and king exposure have been calculated.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate White's candidates, find Black's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 037 | PAGE 4

Decode: h4 creates the hook*A pawn becomes a hook only when another pawn can make profitable contact with it.*

LESSON 038 | PAGE 8

Play: h4 creates the hook*A pawn becomes a hook only when another pawn can make profitable contact with it.*

LESSON 039 | PAGE 12

Decode: h5 fixes the kingside*Fix a pawn only when your pieces can attack the fixed square.*

LESSON 040 | PAGE 16

Play: h5 fixes the kingside*Fix a pawn only when your pieces can attack the fixed square.*

LESSON 041 | PAGE 20

Decode: g4-g5 and the knight chase*A pawn chase is good only when the chased piece loses function, not merely location.*

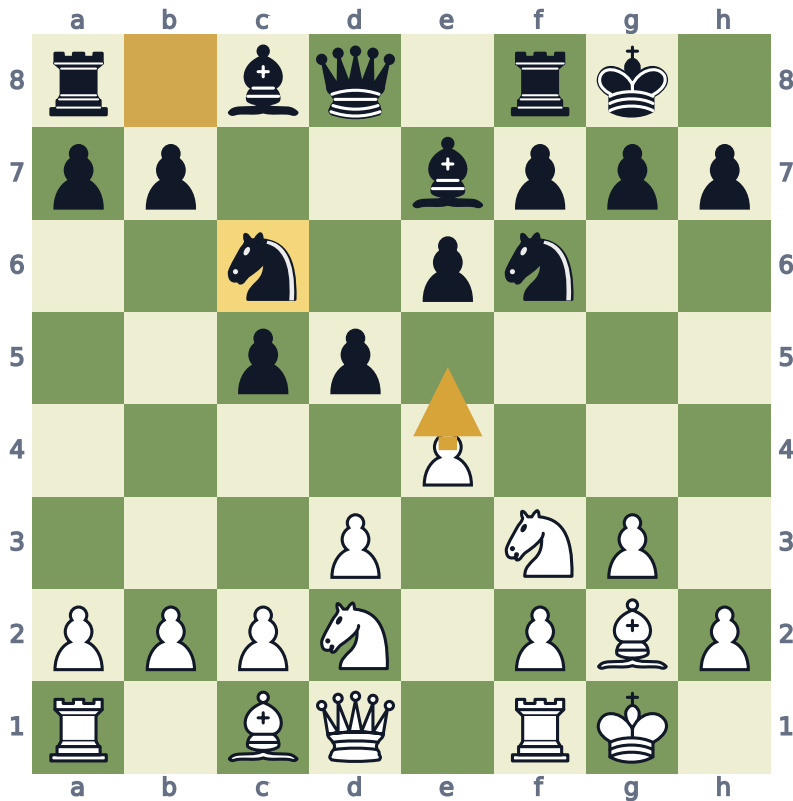
LESSON 042 | PAGE 24

Play: g4-g5 and the knight chase*A pawn chase is good only when the chased piece loses function, not merely location.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will advance kingside pawns only when the resulting files, squares, and king exposure have been calculated.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: h4 creates the hook



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

h4 prepares h5 against ...h6 or a direct gain of space, while keeping the g-pawn available; it also loosens g3 and the white king.

DECISION RULE

If Black ignores h4, what is White's next forcing move; if Black plays ...h6, which pawn becomes the target?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black responds with ...f6, ...h6, or queenside speed and avoids creating a hook unless it serves a defensive purpose.

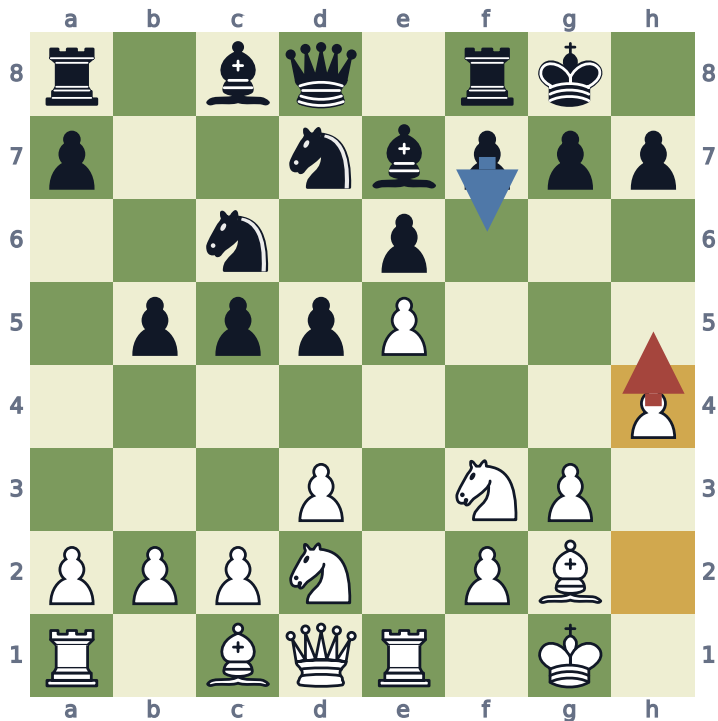
WHITE'S PLAN

White uses h4 to force a pawn decision, then opens the h-file only when a rook or queen can reach it.

MEMORY RULE | A pawn becomes a hook only when another pawn can make profitable contact with it.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

h4 prepares h5 against ...h6 or a direct gain of space, while keeping the g-pawn available; it also loosens g3 and the white king.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black responds with ...f6, ...h6, or queenside speed and avoids creating a hook unless it serves a defensive purpose.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White uses h4 to force a pawn decision, then opens the h-file only when a rook or queen can reach it.

FAILURE MODE

Advancing h4-h5 while the h-file would open for Black's rook or White cannot bring a heavy piece.

DECISION TEST

Ask: If Black ignores h4, what is White's next forcing move; if Black plays ...h6, which pawn becomes the target? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

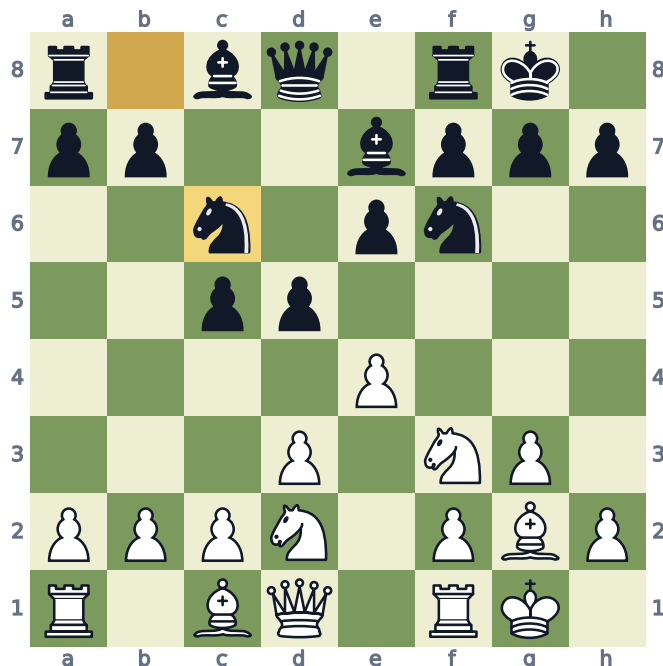
RULE | A pawn becomes a hook only when another pawn can make profitable contact with it.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4



- g3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

h4 prepares h5 against ...h6 or a direct gain of space, while keeping the g-pawn available; it also loosens g3 and the white king.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

If Black ignores h4, what is White's next forcing move; if Black plays ...h6, which pawn becomes the target? White's attacking or positional plan is: White uses h4 to force a pawn decision, then opens the h-file only when a rook or queen can reach it. The line fails as a template when: Advancing h4-h5 while the h-file would open for Black's rook or White cannot bring a heavy piece.

STORE THIS | A pawn becomes a hook only when another pawn can make profitable contact with it.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

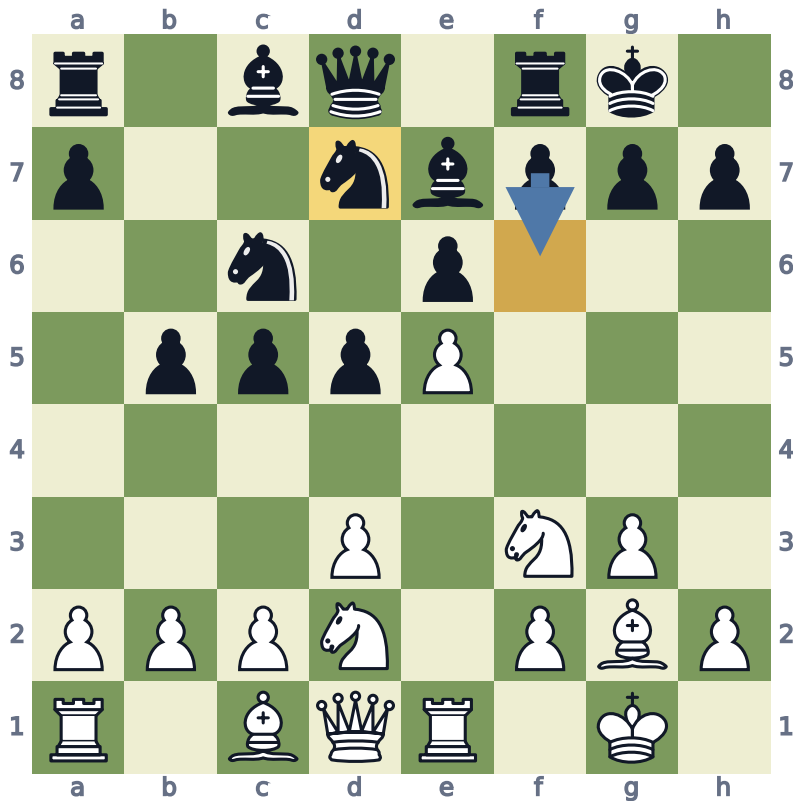
1. h4 prepares h5 against ...h6 or a direct gain of space, while keeping the g-pawn available; it also loosens g3 and the white king. 2. Black responds with ...f6, ...h6, or queenside speed and avoids creating a hook unless it serves a defensive purpose. 3. White uses h4 to force a pawn decision, then opens the h-file only when a rook or queen can reach it. 4. If Black ignores h4, what is White's next forcing move; if Black plays ...h6, which pawn becomes the target? 5. Advancing h4-h5 while the h-file would open for Black's rook or White cannot bring a heavy piece.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: h4 creates the hook



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

h4 prepares h5 against ...h6 or a direct gain of space, while keeping the g-pawn available; it also loosens g3 and the white king.

DECISION RULE

If Black ignores h4, what is White's next forcing move; if Black plays ...h6, which pawn becomes the target?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black responds with ...f6, ...h6, or queenside speed and avoids creating a hook unless it serves a defensive purpose.

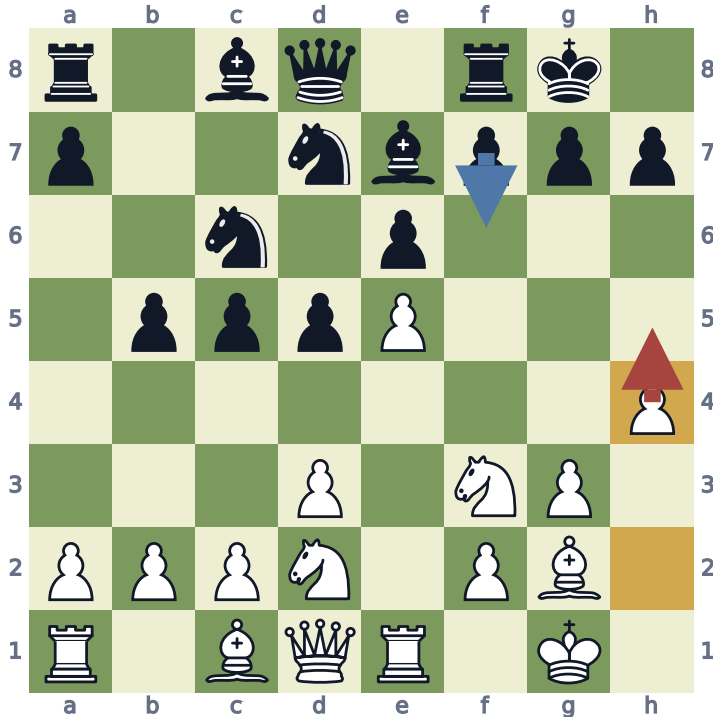
WHITE'S PLAN

White uses h4 to force a pawn decision, then opens the h-file only when a rook or queen can reach it.

MEMORY RULE | A pawn becomes a hook only when another pawn can make profitable contact with it.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

h4 prepares h5 against ...h6 or a direct gain of space, while keeping the g-pawn available; it also loosens g3 and the white king.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black responds with ...f6, ...h6, or queenside speed and avoids creating a hook unless it serves a defensive purpose.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White uses h4 to force a pawn decision, then opens the h-file only when a rook or queen can reach it.

FAILURE MODE

Advancing h4-h5 while the h-file would open for Black's rook or White cannot bring a heavy piece.

DECISION TEST

Ask: If Black ignores h4, what is White's next forcing move; if Black plays ...h6, which pawn becomes the target? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

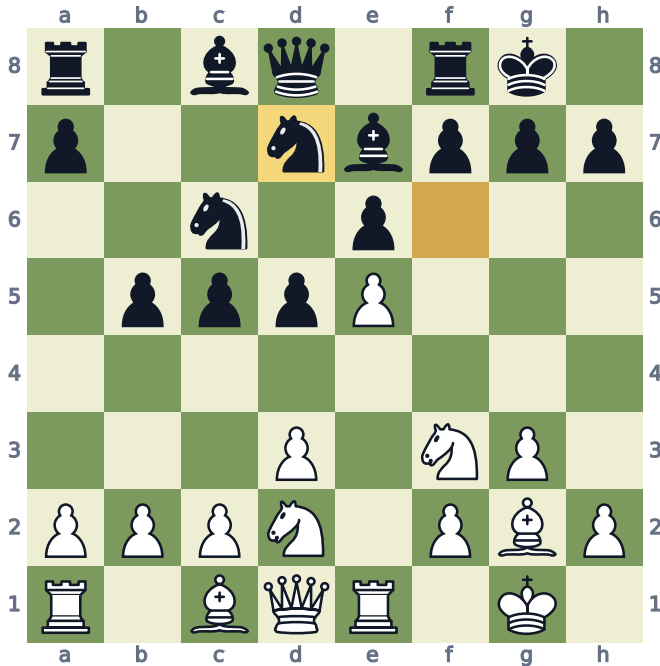
RULE | A pawn becomes a hook only when another pawn can make profitable contact with it.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4



- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.
- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

h4 prepares h5 against ...h6 or a direct gain of space, while keeping the g-pawn available; it also loosens g3 and the white king.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

If Black ignores h4, what is White's next forcing move; if Black plays ...h6, which pawn becomes the target? White's attacking or positional plan is: White uses h4 to force a pawn decision, then opens the h-file only when a rook or queen can reach it. The line fails as a template when: Advancing h4-h5 while the h-file would open for Black's rook or White cannot bring a heavy piece.

STORE THIS | A pawn becomes a hook only when another pawn can make profitable contact with it.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

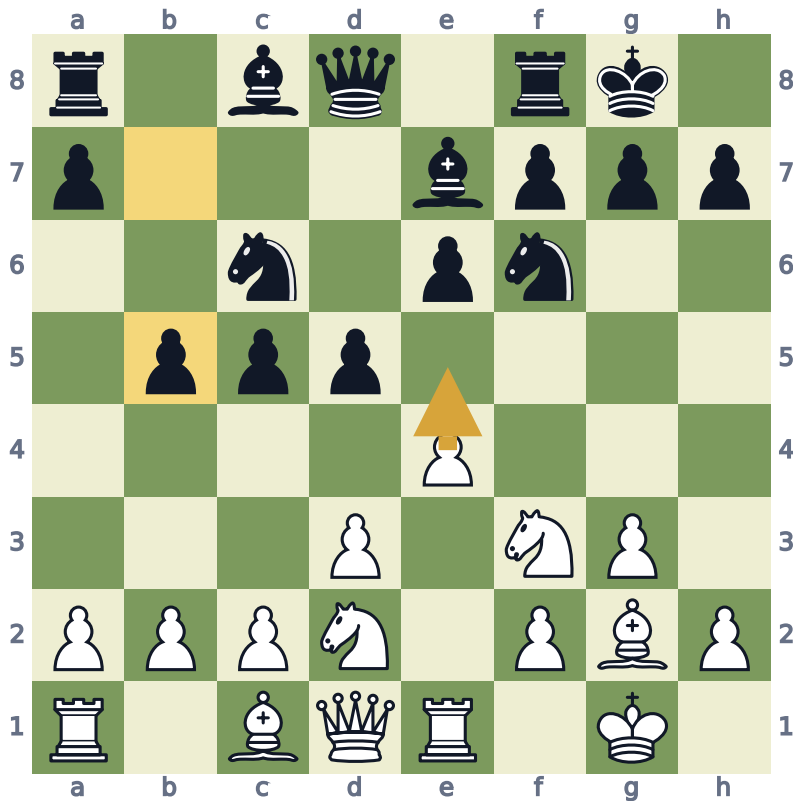
1. h4 prepares h5 against ...h6 or a direct gain of space, while keeping the g-pawn available; it also loosens g3 and the white king. 2. Black responds with ...f6, ...h6, or queenside speed and avoids creating a hook unless it serves a defensive purpose. 3. White uses h4 to force a pawn decision, then opens the h-file only when a rook or queen can reach it. 4. If Black ignores h4, what is White's next forcing move; if Black plays ...h6, which pawn becomes the target? 5. Advancing h4-h5 while the h-file would open for Black's rook or White cannot bring a heavy piece.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: h5 fixes the kingside



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

h5 restricts ...g6 and fixes h7, but it can also close the h-file and leave White needing a different entry route.

DECISION RULE

Did h5 create a target that White can attack, or did it lock the only file White could open?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black keeps the structure closed, attacks d3, and uses ...f6 to challenge the center rather than weakening the h-pawn shell.

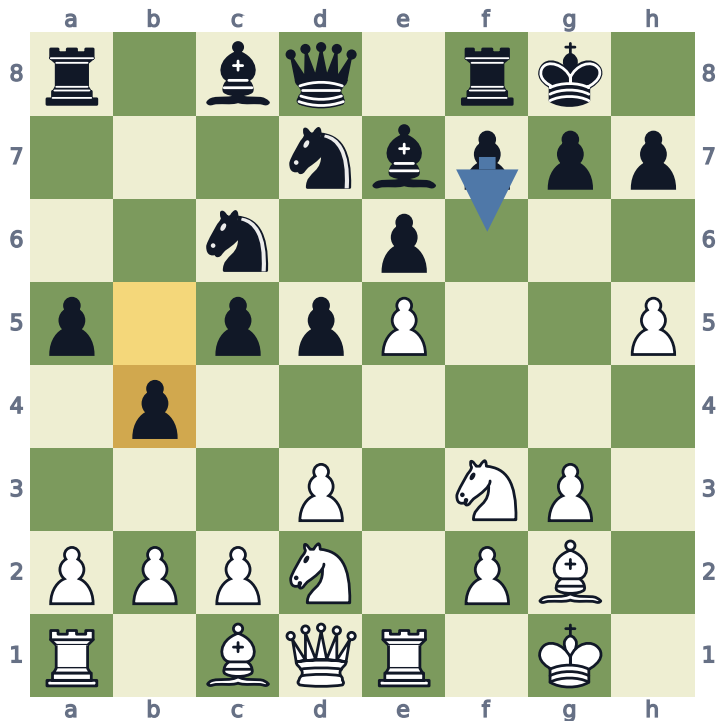
WHITE'S PLAN

White combines h5 with Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, and queen access so the fixed pawn becomes a target.

MEMORY RULE | Fix a pawn only when your pieces can attack the fixed square.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

h5 restricts ...g6 and fixes h7, but it can also close the h-file and leave White needing a different entry route.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black keeps the structure closed, attacks d3, and uses ...f6 to challenge the center rather than weakening the h-pawn shell.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White combines h5 with Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, and queen access so the fixed pawn becomes a target.

FAILURE MODE

Confusing territorial gain with line access and discovering that every kingside file is closed.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Did h5 create a target that White can attack, or did it lock the only file White could open? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

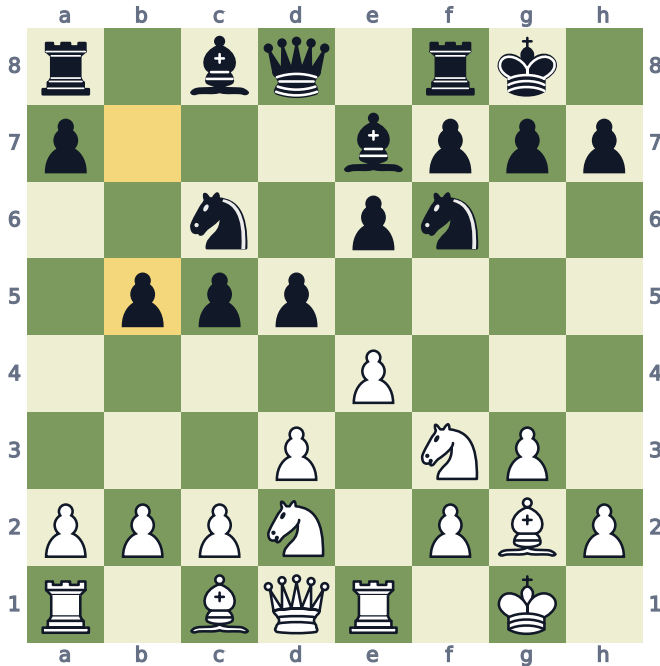
RULE | Fix a pawn only when your pieces can attack the fixed square.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. h5 b4



- Bg2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the pawn break that will make the diagonal useful.
- c5: Black attacks d4 and accelerates queenside expansion.
- O-O: White secures the king and activates a rook; the center can now close or open with less tactical risk.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

h5 restricts ...g6 and fixes h7, but it can also close the h-file and leave White needing a different entry route.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Did h5 create a target that White can attack, or did it lock the only file White could open? White's attacking or positional plan is: White combines h5 with Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, and queen access so the fixed pawn becomes a target. The line fails as a template when: Confusing territorial gain with line access and discovering that every kingside file is closed.

STORE THIS | Fix a pawn only when your pieces can attack the fixed square.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

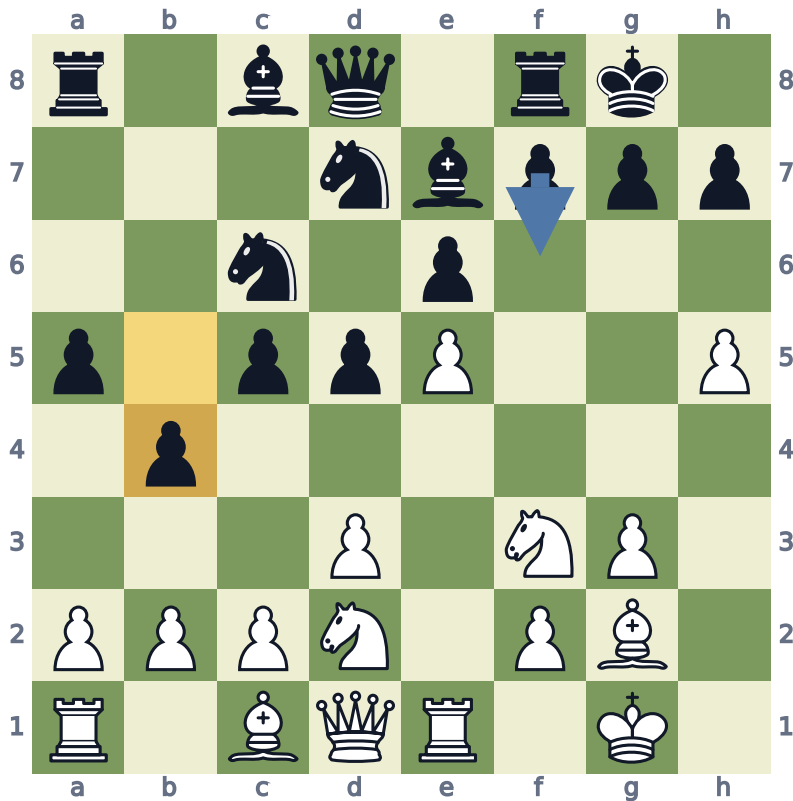
1. h5 restricts ...g6 and fixes h7, but it can also close the h-file and leave White needing a different entry route. 2. Black keeps the structure closed, attacks d3, and uses ...f6 to challenge the center rather than weakening the h-pawn shell. 3. White combines h5 with Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, and queen access so the fixed pawn becomes a target. 4. Did h5 create a target that White can attack, or did it lock the only file White could open? 5. Confusing territorial gain with line access and discovering that every kingside file is closed.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: h5 fixes the kingside



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

h5 restricts ...g6 and fixes h7, but it can also close the h-file and leave White needing a different entry route.

DECISION RULE

Did h5 create a target that White can attack, or did it lock the only file White could open?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black keeps the structure closed, attacks d3, and uses ...f6 to challenge the center rather than weakening the h-pawn shell.

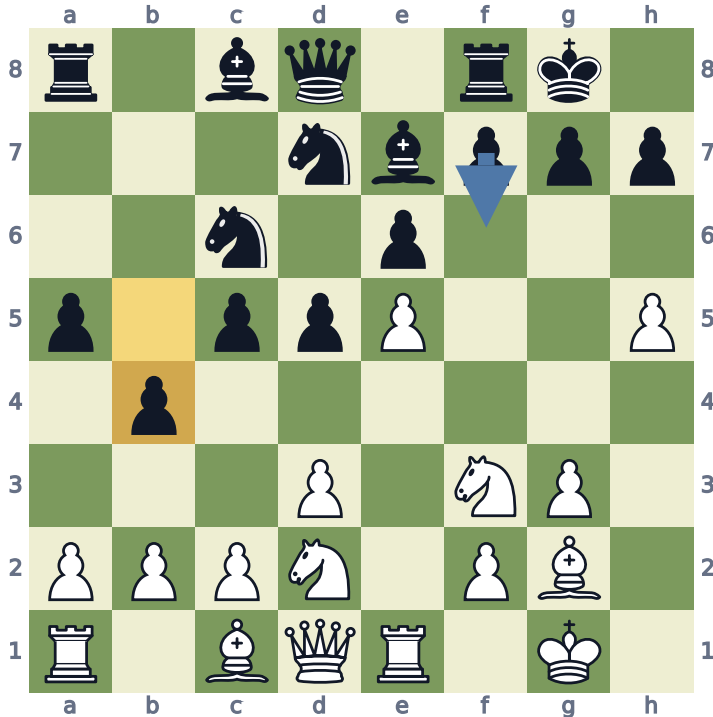
WHITE'S PLAN

White combines h5 with Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, and queen access so the fixed pawn becomes a target.

MEMORY RULE | Fix a pawn only when your pieces can attack the fixed square.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

h5 restricts ...g6 and fixes h7, but it can also close the h-file and leave White needing a different entry route.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black keeps the structure closed, attacks d3, and uses ...f6 to challenge the center rather than weakening the h-pawn shell.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White combines h5 with Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, and queen access so the fixed pawn becomes a target.

FAILURE MODE

Confusing territorial gain with line access and discovering that every kingside file is closed.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Did h5 create a target that White can attack, or did it lock the only file White could open? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

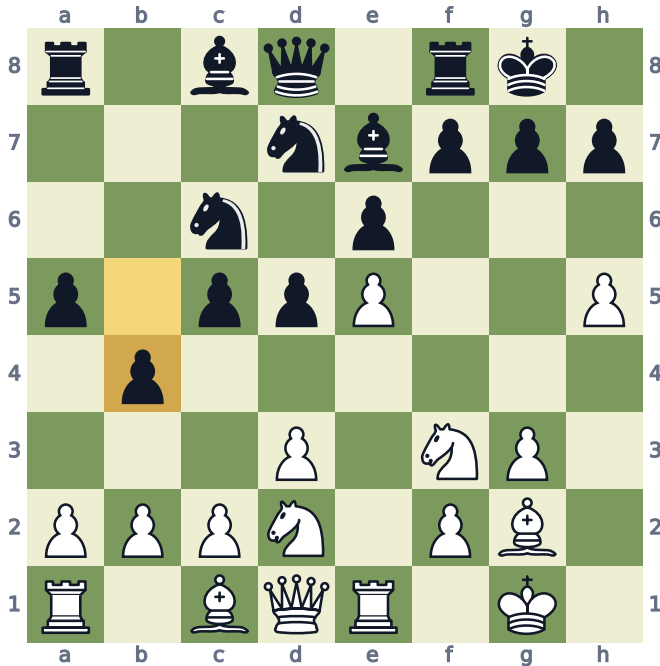
RULE | Fix a pawn only when your pieces can attack the fixed square.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. h5 b4



- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- h4: White creates a possible kingside hook and supports h5.
- a5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- h5: White fixes kingside squares and asks whether White can attack the fixed pawn.
- b4: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

h5 restricts ...g6 and fixes h7, but it can also close the h-file and leave White needing a different entry route.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Did h5 create a target that White can attack, or did it lock the only file White could open? White's attacking or positional plan is: White combines h5 with Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, and queen access so the fixed pawn becomes a target. The line fails as a template when: Confusing territorial gain with line access and discovering that every kingside file is closed.

STORE THIS | Fix a pawn only when your pieces can attack the fixed square.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

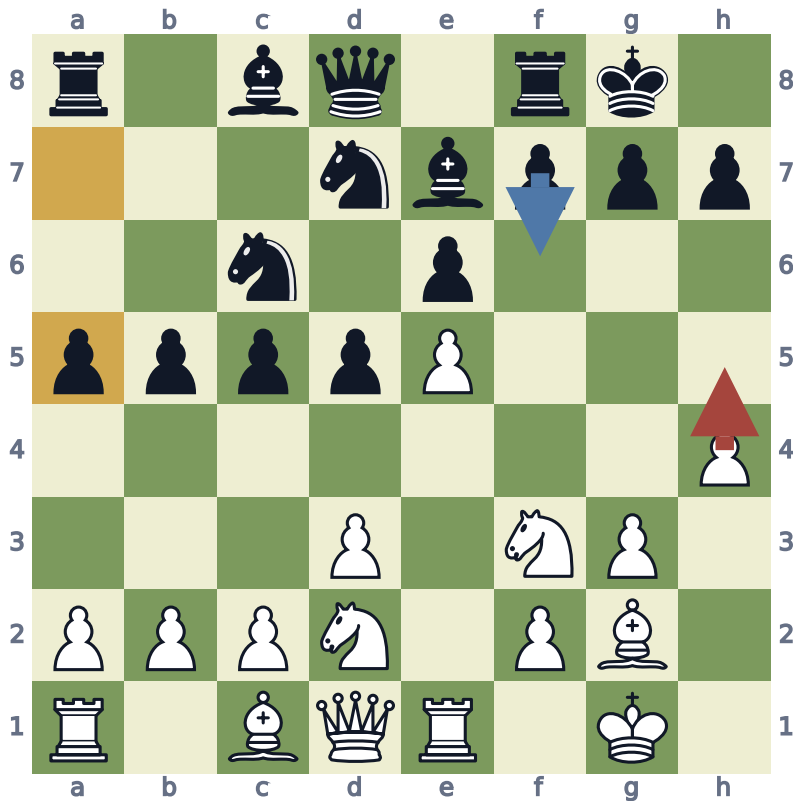
1. h5 restricts ...g6 and fixes h7, but it can also close the h-file and leave White needing a different entry route. 2. Black keeps the structure closed, attacks d3, and uses ...f6 to challenge the center rather than weakening the h-pawn shell. 3. White combines h5 with Nf1-h2-g4, Bf4, and queen access so the fixed pawn becomes a target. 4. Did h5 create a target that White can attack, or did it lock the only file White could open? 5. Confusing territorial gain with line access and discovering that every kingside file is closed.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 22 plies from memory, then replay: 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. h5 b4

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: g4-g5 and the knight chase



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

g4-g5 gains space and can drive a defender from f6, but it opens dark squares around White's own king and may leave the g-pawn unsupported.

DECISION RULE

Where does the targeted knight go, and does that retreat attack e5, g5, or White's king?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black opens the center or queenside, challenges g5 with ...f6, and uses the weakened f4 and h4 squares.

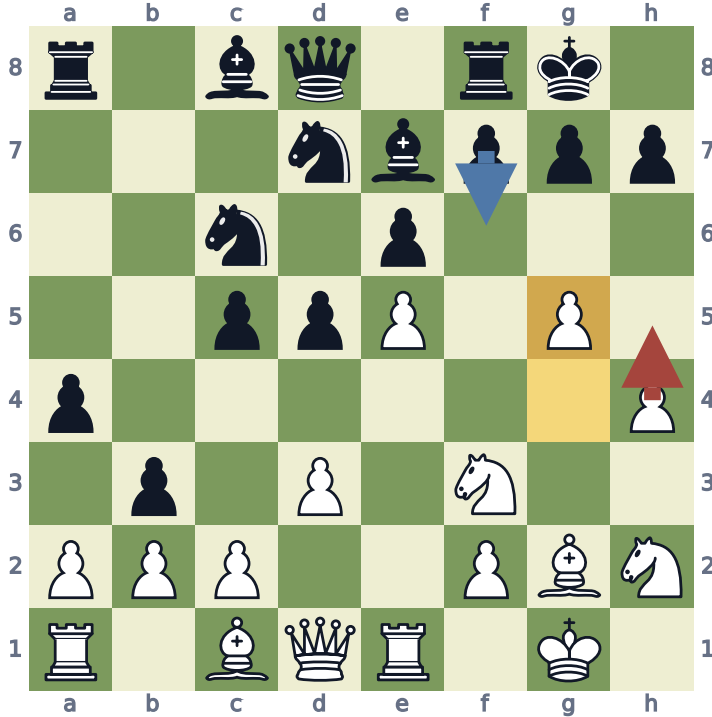
WHITE'S PLAN

White pushes only when the knight displacement or opened g-file produces a forcing continuation.

MEMORY RULE | A pawn chase is good only when the chased piece loses function, not merely location.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

g4-g5 gains space and can drive a defender from f6, but it opens dark squares around White's own king and may leave the g-pawn unsupported.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black opens the center or queenside, challenges g5 with ...f6, and uses the weakened f4 and h4 squares.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White pushes only when the knight displacement or opened g-file produces a forcing continuation.

FAILURE MODE

Chasing a knight to a better defensive square while weakening the castled king.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Where does the targeted knight go, and does that retreat attack e5, g5, or White's king? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

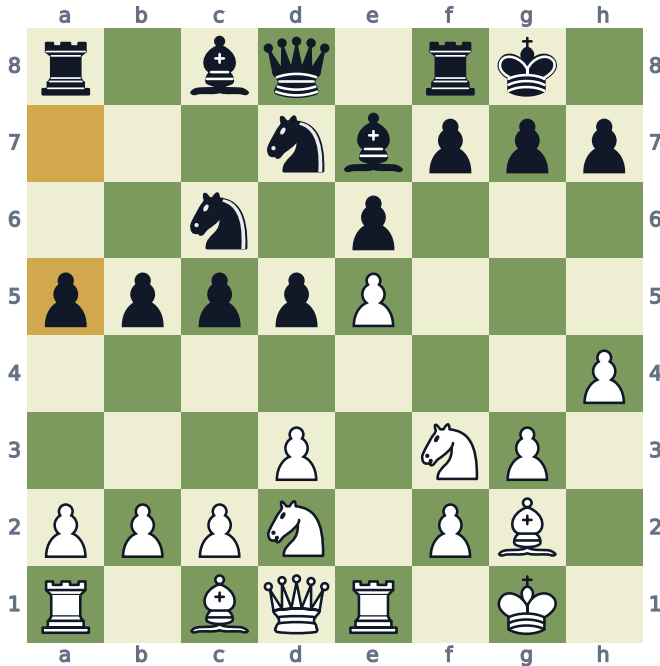
RULE | A pawn chase is good only when the chased piece loses function, not merely location.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. N1h2 a4 13. g4 b3 14. g5



- Re1: White places a rook behind a pawn break or file expected to open.
- b5: Black gains queenside space and begins the race against White's king attack.
- e5: White gains kingside space and drives the f6 knight while fixing a pawn-chain target.
- Nd7: Black reroutes a knight to d7; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- h4: White creates a possible kingside hook and supports h5.
- a5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

g4-g5 gains space and can drive a defender from f6, but it opens dark squares around White's own king and may leave the g-pawn unsupported.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Where does the targeted knight go, and does that retreat attack e5, g5, or White's king? White's attacking or positional plan is: White pushes only when the knight displacement or opened g-file produces a forcing continuation. The line fails as a template when: Chasing a knight to a better defensive square while weakening the castled king.

STORE THIS | A pawn chase is good only when the chased piece loses function, not merely location.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

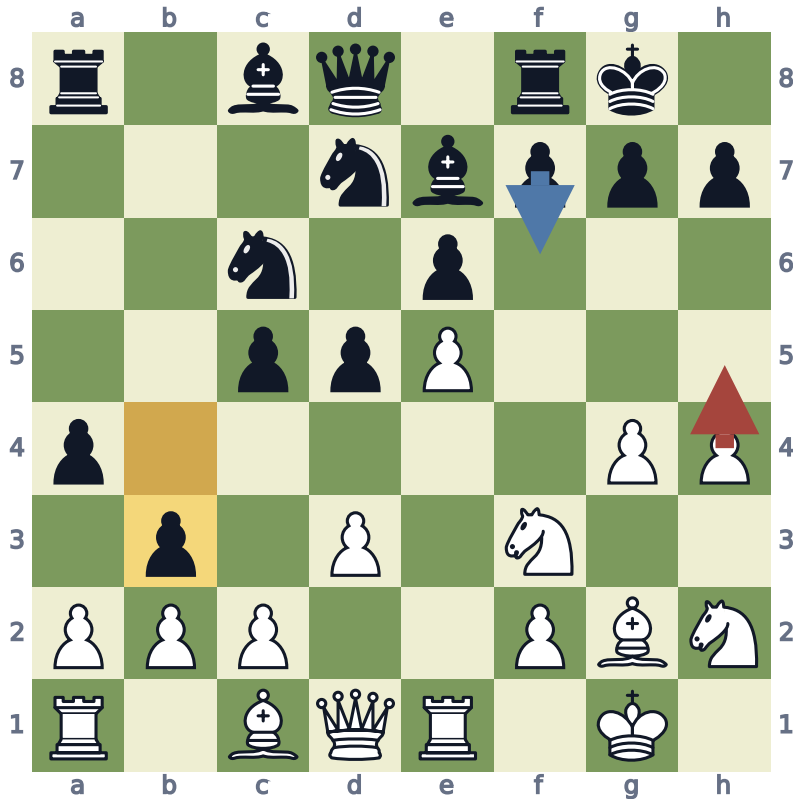
1. g4-g5 gains space and can drive a defender from f6, but it opens dark squares around White's own king and may leave the g-pawn unsupported. 2. Black opens the center or queenside, challenges g5 with ...f6, and uses the weakened f4 and h4 squares. 3. White pushes only when the knight displacement or opened g-file produces a forcing continuation. 4. Where does the targeted knight go, and does that retreat attack e5, g5, or White's king? 5. Chasing a knight to a better defensive square while weakening the castled king.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 20 plies from memory, then replay: 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: g4-g5 and the knight chase



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

g4-g5 gains space and can drive a defender from f6, but it opens dark squares around White's own king and may leave the g-pawn unsupported.

DECISION RULE

Where does the targeted knight go, and does that retreat attack e5, g5, or White's king?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S COUNTERPLAY

Black opens the center or queenside, challenges g5 with ...f6, and uses the weakened f4 and h4 squares.

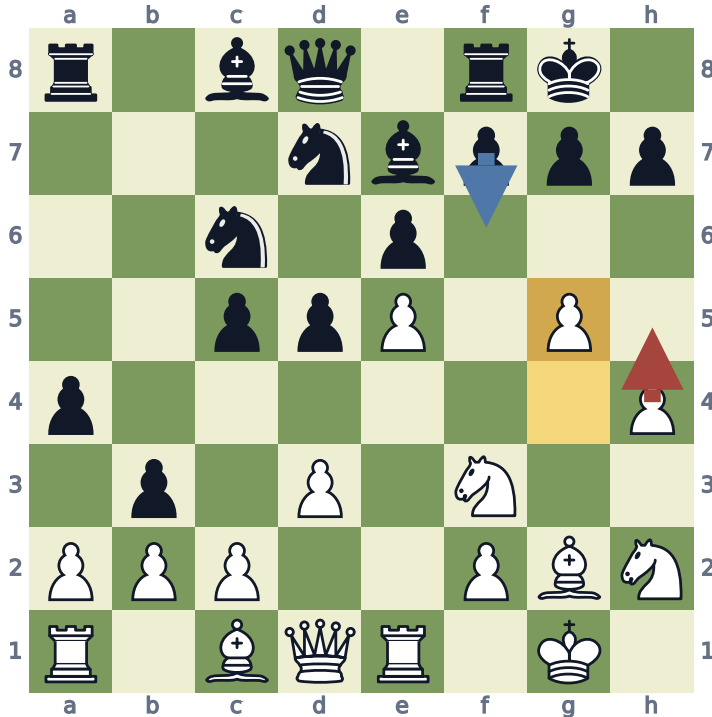
WHITE'S PLAN

White pushes only when the knight displacement or opened g-file produces a forcing continuation.

MEMORY RULE | A pawn chase is good only when the chased piece loses function, not merely location.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

g4-g5 gains space and can drive a defender from f6, but it opens dark squares around White's own king and may leave the g-pawn unsupported.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Black opens the center or queenside, challenges g5 with ...f6, and uses the weakened f4 and h4 squares.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL PLAN

White pushes only when the knight displacement or opened g-file produces a forcing continuation.

FAILURE MODE

Chasing a knight to a better defensive square while weakening the castled king.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Where does the targeted knight go, and does that retreat attack e5, g5, or White's king? Then compare at least two White candidates against Black's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

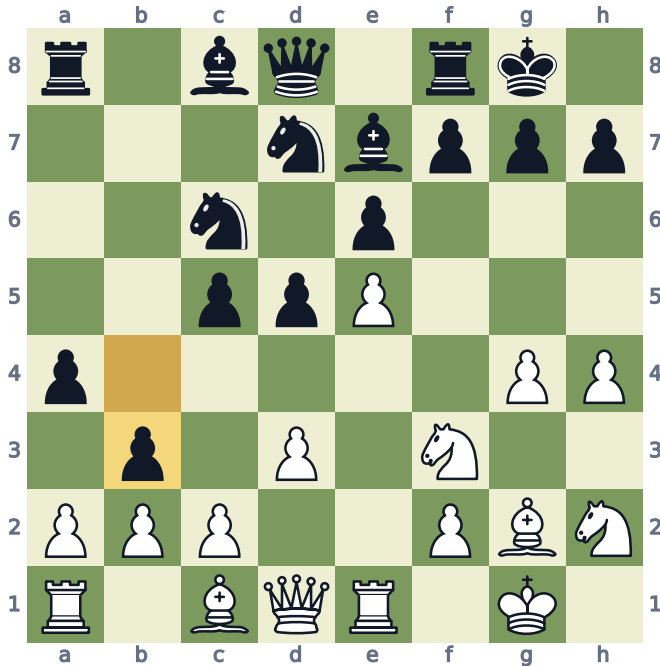
RULE | A pawn chase is good only when the chased piece loses function, not merely location.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. N1h2 a4 13. g4 b3 14. g5



- Nf1: White reroutes a knight to f1; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- b4: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- N1h2: White reroutes a knight to h2; name the destination job and the useful move conceded to the opponent.
- a4: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- g4: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.
- b3: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess the chain, breaks, weak squares, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

g4-g5 gains space and can drive a defender from f6, but it opens dark squares around White's own king and may leave the g-pawn unsupported.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Where does the targeted knight go, and does that retreat attack e5, g5, or White's king? White's attacking or positional plan is: White pushes only when the knight displacement or opened g-file produces a forcing continuation. The line fails as a template when: Chasing a knight to a better defensive square while weakening the castled king.

STORE THIS | A pawn chase is good only when the chased piece loses function, not merely location.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's most urgent counterplay, and which pawn break enables it?

3. What is White's primary plan, and which piece or pawn makes it work?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. g4-g5 gains space and can drive a defender from f6, but it opens dark squares around White's own king and may leave the g-pawn unsupported. 2. Black opens the center or queenside, challenges g5 with ...f6, and uses the weakened f4 and h4 squares. 3. White pushes only when the knight displacement or opened g-file produces a forcing continuation. 4. Where does the targeted knight go, and does that retreat attack e5, g5, or White's king? 5. Chasing a knight to a better defensive square while weakening the castled king.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 26 plies from memory, then replay: 11. Nf1 b4 12. N1h2 a4 13. g4 b3

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 037 Decode: h4 creates the hook

Prompt: If Black ignores h4, what is White's next forcing move; if Black plays ...h6, which pawn becomes the target?

Recall: A pawn becomes a hook only when another pawn can make profitable contact with it.

LESSON 038 Play: h4 creates the hook

Prompt: If Black ignores h4, what is White's next forcing move; if Black plays ...h6, which pawn becomes the target?

Recall: A pawn becomes a hook only when another pawn can make profitable contact with it.

LESSON 039 Decode: h5 fixes the kingside

Prompt: Did h5 create a target that White can attack, or did it lock the only file White could open?

Recall: Fix a pawn only when your pieces can attack the fixed square.

LESSON 040 Play: h5 fixes the kingside

Prompt: Did h5 create a target that White can attack, or did it lock the only file White could open?

Recall: Fix a pawn only when your pieces can attack the fixed square.

LESSON 041 Decode: g4-g5 and the knight chase

Prompt: Where does the targeted knight go, and does that retreat attack e5, g5, or White's king?

Recall: A pawn chase is good only when the chased piece loses function, not merely location.

LESSON 042 Play: g4-g5 and the knight chase

Prompt: Where does the targeted knight go, and does that retreat attack e5, g5, or White's king?

Recall: A pawn chase is good only when the chased piece loses function, not merely location.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's counterplay, White's plan, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

h4 creates the hook

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4

Decision: If Black ignores h4, what is White's next forcing move; if Black plays ...h6, which pawn becomes the target?

Memory: A pawn becomes a hook only when another pawn can make profitable contact with it.

CARD 2

h5 fixes the kingside

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. h5 b4

Decision: Did h5 create a target that White can attack, or did it lock the only file White could open?

Memory: Fix a pawn only when your pieces can attack the fixed square.

CARD 3

g4-g5 and the knight chase

1. e4 e6 2. d3 d5 3. Nd2 Nf6 4. Ngf3 Be7 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 c5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 b5 9. e5 Nd7 10. h4 a5 11. Nf1 b4 12. N1h2 a4 13. g4 b3 14. g5

Decision: Where does the targeted knight go, and does that retreat attack e5, g5, or White's king?

Memory: A pawn chase is good only when the chased piece loses function, not merely location.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
037 Decode: h4 creates the hook	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
038 Play: h4 creates the hook	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
039 Decode: h5 fixes the kingside	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
040 Play: h5 fixes the kingside	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
041 Decode: g4-g5 and the knight chase	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
042 Play: g4-g5 and the knight chase	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name Black's strongest counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.